

The Po

Location From the Alps to the Adriatic Sea, northern Italy

The Po, Italy's longest river at 405 miles (652km), takes water from the country's largest drainage basin, including its most fertile plain. It descends steeply from its source in the Cottian Alps, but from Turin follows a more gentle descent as it passes across a broad, flat plain. It is connected to Milan by a series of channels. Then it flows more

or less due east to its delta, the most complex of any European river, with at least 14 mouths entering the Adriatic Sea.

The Plitvice Lakes

Location The Velebit Mountains, Croatia

This stepped series of 16 lakes and interconnecting waterfalls cascades down the Korana River in the forested limestone landscape of the Velebit Mountains. Over the

course of 5 miles (8km), the river falls in elevation by 440ft (133m). The waters of the river contain high concentrations of calcium carbonate, some of which is deposited to form travertine barriers, which dam the lakes. As water flows over the top of the dams, it forms waterfalls, the highest of which—Veliki Slap—drops 256ft (78m). The river runs through a gorge, and its valley includes other karst features, such as caves and underground streams.

▼ WATERFALLS AND LIMESTONE HILLS AT PLITVICE LAKES NATIONAL PARK

Bigar Waterfall

Location The Anina Mountains, southwest Romania

Located in the Caraș-Severin County, Romania's most famous waterfall is neither spectacularly high nor thunderously powerful, but what it lacks in size it more than makes up for in beauty. The Bigar Waterfall is a stream flowing into the Miniș River gorge over a 25-ft- (8-m-) high domed rock overhanging the river below.

